

Basketball Basics for New Players and Coaches -- Learn the Basic Rules, Concepts, Court Layout, and Player Positions

The rules of basketball, thankfully, are fairly straightforward.

However, if you're coaching younger players, these rules can be easily forgotten once they take the floor.

The three-second rule (which we'll discuss later in this article) is just one of many great examples.

But before you can teach the rules to your team, you must know them yourself.

So keep reading, because by the end of this article, you'll be up to speed on all the basketball rules so you can teach your players and help them develop throughout the season!

The Rules

Basketball is a team sport.

Two teams of five players each try to score by shooting a ball through a hoop elevated 10 feet above the ground.

The game is played on a rectangular floor called the court, and there is a hoop at each end.

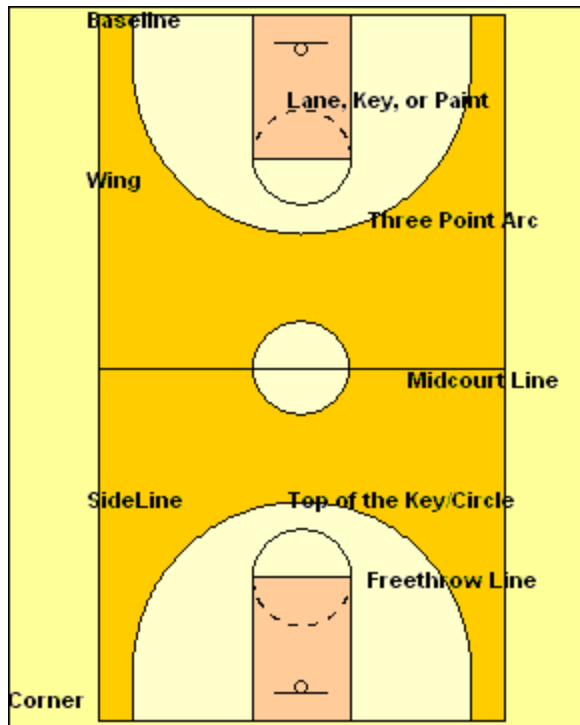
The court is divided into two main sections by the mid-court line.

If the offensive team puts the ball into play behind the mid-court line, it has ten seconds to get the ball over the mid-court line.

If it doesn't, then the defense gets the ball.

Once the offensive team gets the ball over the mid-court line, it can no longer have possession of the ball in the area behind the midcourt line.

If it does, the defense is awarded the ball.



Basketball Court 1

The ball is moved down the court toward the basket by passing or dribbling. The team with the ball is called the offense. The team without the ball is called the defense.

The defense tries to steal the ball, contest shots, deflect passes, and garner rebounds.

These concepts are taught to players at our [basketball camps](#) across the country.

Points

When a team makes a basket, they score two points and the ball goes to the other team.

If a basket, or field goal, is made outside of the three-point arc, then that basket is worth three points. A free throw is worth one point.

Free throws are awarded to a team according to some formats involving the number of fouls committed in a half and/or the type of foul committed.

Fouling a shooter always results in two or three free throws being awarded the shooter, depending upon where he was when he shot. If he was beyond the three-point line, then he gets three shots.

Other types of fouls do not result in free throws being awarded until a certain number have accumulated during a half (called “team fouls”).

Once that number is reached, then the player who was fouled is awarded a '1-and-1' opportunity. If he makes his first free throw, he gets to attempt a second. If he misses the first shot, the ball is live on the rebound.

Game Clock

Each game is divided into sections, and all levels have two halves.

In college, each half is twenty minutes long.

In high school and below, the halves are divided into eight (and sometimes, six) minute quarters. In the pros, quarters are twelve minutes long.

There is a gap of several minutes between halves. Gaps between quarters are relatively short.

If the score is tied at the end of regulation, then overtime periods of various lengths are played until a winner emerges.

Basket Assignment and Tip-Off

Also, each team is assigned a [basket or goal](#) to defend.

This means that the other basket is their scoring basket.

At halftime, the teams switch goals.

The game begins with one player from either team at center court.

A referee will toss the ball up between the two. The player that gets his hands on the ball will tip it to a teammate. This is called a tip-off.

Fouls and Violations

In addition to stealing the ball from an opposing player, there are other ways for a team to get the ball.

One such way is if the other team commits a foul or violation.

FOULS

Personal fouls: Personal fouls include any type of illegal physical contact.

- Hitting
- Pushing
- Slapping
- Holding
- Illegal pick/screen -- when an offensive player is moving. When an offensive player sticks out a limb and makes physical contact with a defender in an attempt to block the path of the defender.

Personal foul penalties: If a player is shooting while being fouled, then he gets two free throws if his shot doesn't go in, but only one free throw if his shot does go in.

- Three free throws are awarded if the player is fouled while shooting for a three-point goal and they miss their shot. If a player is fouled while shooting a three-point shot and makes it anyway, he is awarded one free throw. Thus, he could score four points on the play.
- Inbounds. If fouled while not shooting, the ball is given to the team the foul was committed upon. They get the ball at the nearest side or baseline, out of bounds, and have 5 seconds to pass the ball onto the court.
- One & one. If the team committing the foul has seven or more fouls in the game, then the player who was fouled is awarded one free throw. If he makes his first shot, then he is awarded another free throw.
- Ten or more fouls. If the team committing the foul has ten or more fouls, then the fouled player receives two free throws.

Charging. An offensive foul that is committed when a player pushes or runs over a defensive player. The ball is given to the team that the foul was committed upon.

Blocking. Blocking is illegal personal contact resulting from a defender not establishing position in time to prevent an opponent's drive to the basket.

Flagrant foul. Violent contact with an opponent. This includes hitting, kicking, and punching. This type of foul results in free throws plus the offense retaining possession of the ball after the free throws.

Intentional foul. When a player makes physical contact with another player with no reasonable effort to steal the ball. It is a judgment call for the officials.

Technical foul. Technical foul. A player or a coach can commit this type of foul. It does not involve player contact or the ball but is instead about the 'manners' of the game. Foul language, obscenity, obscene gestures, and even arguing can be considered a technical foul, as can technical details regarding filling in the scorebook improperly or dunking during warm-ups.

VIOLATIONS

Walking/Traveling. Taking more than 'a step and a half' without dribbling the ball is traveling. Moving your pivot foot once you've stopped dribbling is traveling.

Carrying/palming. When a player dribbles the ball with his hand too far to the side of or, sometimes, even under the ball.

Double Dribble. Dribbling the ball with both hands on the ball at the same time or picking up the dribble and then dribbling again is a double dribble.

Held ball. Occasionally, two or more opposing players will gain possession of the ball at the same time. In order to avoid a prolonged and/or violent tussle, the referee stops the action and awards the ball to one team or the other on a rotating basis.

Goaltending. If a defensive player interferes with a shot while it's on the way down toward the basket, while it's on the way up toward the basket after having touched the backboard, or while it's in the cylinder above the rim, it's goaltending and the shot counts. If committed by an offensive player, it's a violation and the ball is awarded to the opposing team for a throw-in.

Backcourt violation. Once the offense has brought the ball across the mid-court line, they cannot go back across the line during possession. If they do, the ball is awarded to the other team to pass inbounds.

Time restrictions. A player passing the ball inbounds has five seconds to pass the ball. If he does not, then the ball is awarded to the other team. Other time restrictions include the rule that a player cannot have the ball for more than five seconds when being closely guarded and, in some states and levels, shot-clock restrictions requiring a team to attempt a shot within a given time frame.

Player Positions

Center. Centers are generally your tallest players. They generally are positioned near the basket.

Offensive -- The center's goal is to get open for a pass and to shoot. They are also responsible for blocking defenders, known as picking or screening, to open other players up for driving to the basket for a goal. Centers are expected to get some offensive rebounds and put-backs.

Defensive -- On defense, the center's main responsibility is to keep opponents from shooting by blocking shots and passes in the key area. They also are expected to get a lot of rebounds because they're taller.

Forward. Your next tallest players will most likely be your forwards. While a forward may be called upon to play under the hoop, they may also be required to operate in the wings and corner areas.

Offensive -- Forwards are responsible to get free for a pass, take outside shots, drive for goals, and rebound.

Defensive -- Responsibilities include preventing drives to the goal and rebounding.

Guard. These are potentially your shortest players and they should be really good at dribbling fast, seeing the court, and passing. It is their job to bring the ball down the court and set up offensive plays.

Offensive -- Dribbling, passing, and setting up offensive plays are a guard's main responsibilities. They also need to be able to drive to the basket and to shoot from the perimeter.

Defensive -- On defense, a guard is responsible for stealing passes, contesting shots, preventing drives to the hoop, and for boxing out.

SUPLEMEN MATERI BOLA BASKET: DASAR, POSISI, DAN SEJARAH

1. Peraturan Dasar & Pelanggaran (Basic Rules & Fouls)

- **Traveling:** Membawa bola lebih dari dua langkah tanpa melakukan dribble.
- **Double Dribble:** Melakukan dribble kembali setelah sebelumnya berhenti memegang bola dengan kedua tangan.
- **Personal Foul:** Kontak fisik ilegal dengan lawan. Pemain NBA biasanya dikeluarkan setelah 6 kali foul, sedangkan FIBA setelah 5 kali foul.
- **Technical Foul:** Pelanggaran yang tidak melibatkan kontak fisik, seperti protes keras ke wasit atau perilaku tidak sportif.
- **Three-Second Violation:** Pemain menyerang tidak boleh berdiri di dalam area terlarang (key area) lawan selama lebih dari tiga detik berturut-turut.

2. Posisi dan Tipe Pemain (Player Positions)

Dalam basket modern, terdapat 5 posisi standar:

1. **Point Guard (PG):** Pengatur serangan, biasanya pemain dengan kemampuan passing dan dribble terbaik. Disebut juga "Jenderal Lapangan".
2. **Shooting Guard (SG):** Spesialis penembak jarak jauh dan perimeter. Tugas utamanya adalah mencetak angka.
3. **Small Forward (SF):** Pemain serbabisa yang memiliki kemampuan bertahan dan menyerang sama baiknya. Biasanya memiliki postur atletis.
4. **Power Forward (PF):** Bermain di dekat ring, fokus pada rebound dan mencetak angka dari jarak dekat atau menengah.
5. **Center (C):** Pemain tertinggi dalam tim. Bertugas melindungi ring (block shot), melakukan rebound, dan mencetak poin di area *low post*.

3. Jumlah Pemain dan Durasi

- **Jumlah Pemain:** 5 pemain di lapangan untuk masing-masing tim. Total pemain dalam satu roster tim biasanya berkisar antara 12 hingga 15 orang.
- **Durasi (NBA):** 4 kuartir x 12 menit.
- **Durasi (FIBA):** 4 kuartir x 10 menit.
- **Shot Clock:** Waktu yang diberikan kepada tim untuk melepaskan tembakan adalah 24 detik. Jika bola menyentuh ring, waktu kembali ke 14 atau 24 detik.

4. Fakta Sejarah & Pencetak Poin Terbanyak NBA

- **Pencetak Poin Terbanyak Sepanjang Masa (All-Time Leading Scorer):** LeBron James memegang rekor poin terbanyak dalam sejarah NBA, melampaui rekor legendaris Kareem Abdul-Jabbar.
- **Poin Terbanyak dalam Satu Game:** Wilt Chamberlain memegang rekor dengan mencetak 100 poin dalam satu pertandingan pada tahun 1962.
- **Tim Paling Sukses:** Boston Celtics dan Los Angeles Lakers adalah dua tim dengan gelar juara NBA terbanyak.
- **Penemu Basket:** Dr. James Naismith menciptakan permainan ini pada Desember 1891 di Springfield, Massachusetts.

5. Sistem Penilaian (Scoring System)

- **1 Poin:** Diperoleh dari lemparan bebas (free throw) akibat pelanggaran.
- **2 Poin:** Diperoleh dari tembakan di dalam garis tiga angka (layup, jump shot, dunk).
- **3 Poin:** Diperoleh dari tembakan di luar garis busur tiga angka.

BASKETBALL WORKOUT MENU

1. Shooting Workout

Latihan shooting bertujuan meningkatkan akurasi, konsistensi, dan confidence saat pertandingan.

Form Shooting

- 30 tembakan dekat ring
- Fokus pada follow through dan arc bola

Mid Range Shooting

- 5 spot berbeda
- Masing-masing 10 tembakan

3 Point Shooting

- 5 titik perimeter
- 5–10 tembakan per titik

Free Throw Routine

- 50 free throw
- Fokus pada ritme dan pernapasan

Catch & Shoot

- Menerima bola lalu langsung shooting
 - 20 repetisi
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2. Dribbling Workout

Latihan dribbling membantu ball handling, kontrol bola, dan agility.

Low Dribble

- 1 menit tangan kanan
- 1 menit tangan kiri

Crossover Drill

- 3 set × 30 detik
- Fokus perubahan arah cepat

Between The Legs

- 3 set × 30 detik
- Jaga bola tetap rendah

Behind The Back

- 3 set × 30 detik

Cone Dribble

- Dribble melewati cone
- 5 putaran penuh

Speed Dribble

- Full court sprint sambil dribble
 - 10 repetisi
-

3. Finishing Workout

Latihan finishing penting untuk penyelesaian di area ring.

Right Hand Layup

- 20 repetisi

Left Hand Layup

- 20 repetisi

Reverse Layup

- 15 repetisi

Euro Step Finish

- 15 repetisi

Floater

- 20 repetisi

Contact Finish

- Simulasi body contact sebelum layup
 - 15 repetisi
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4. Post Up Workout

Latihan post up untuk pemain yang ingin kuat bermain di paint area.

Back Down Drill

- 10 repetisi

Drop Step Move

- 15 repetisi

Hook Shot

- 20 repetisi tangan kanan & kiri

Up and Under

- 15 repetisi

Spin Move Finish

- 15 repetisi
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5. Defense & Conditioning

Defense dan stamina sangat penting dalam permainan basket modern.

Defensive Slide

- 5 set full court

Close Out Drill

- 10 repetisi

Suicide Run

- 5 putaran

Jump Rope

- 3 menit nonstop

Sprint Training

- Baseline ke baseline
- 10 repetisi

Core Workout

- Plank 1 menit × 3 set
- Sit up 25 × 3 set
- Push up 20 × 3 set

Weekly Training Schedule

Hari	Fokus Latihan
Senin	Shooting + Conditioning
Selasa	Dribbling + Finishing
Rabu	Defense + Post Up
Kamis	Shooting + Ball Handling
Jumat	Game Simulation
Sabtu	Full Workout
Minggu	Recovery & Stretching

Tips Saat Latihan

- Selalu lakukan stretching sebelum latihan
- Fokus pada konsistensi, bukan hanya kecepatan
- Gunakan kedua tangan saat latihan
- Minum air yang cukup
- Evaluasi progress setiap minggu